

DTP & Graphic Design

Detailed Chapter Notes & Worked Examples - Volume 2

This pack develops practical understanding through explanations, worked examples, lab tasks and review questions. Complete the matching Foundation Pack first.

Chapter	Topic
1	Layout and hierarchy
2	Typography and colour
3	Images and vectors
4	Print preflight

Chapter 1: Layout and hierarchy

Concept notes

Hierarchy guides attention using size, weight, spacing and position. Alignment and grids create order; whitespace improves readability.

Worked example

For an A4 course flyer: 12 mm margin, strong headline, three benefit blocks and one admission CTA.

Lab assignment

Sketch two layouts before designing the final flyer.

Review questions

1. What creates hierarchy?
2. Why use a grid?
3. What is whitespace?

Evidence to submit: source file or working output, screenshot/PDF, and a 100-word explanation of decisions and checks.

Chapter 2: Typography and colour

Concept notes

Limit font families, establish type scale and maintain contrast. RGB is for screens; CMYK is commonly used for print production.

Worked example

Use one display face for heading and readable sans serif for body; verify small text and colour contrast.

Lab assignment

Create a typography specimen and three-colour brand palette.

Review questions

1. Difference between RGB and CMYK?
2. What is leading?
3. Why limit fonts?

Evidence to submit: source file or working output, screenshot/PDF, and a 100-word explanation of decisions and checks.

Chapter 3: Images and vectors

Concept notes

Raster images depend on resolution; vectors scale through paths. Preserve original files and edit non-destructively where possible.

Worked example

A logo should remain vector; a photograph may be prepared at required print dimensions and resolution.

Lab assignment

Create one vector icon set and one corrected photo composition.

Review questions

1. When choose vector?
2. What causes pixelation?
3. Why keep source layers?

Evidence to submit: source file or working output, screenshot/PDF, and a 100-word explanation of decisions and checks.

Chapter 4: Print preflight

Concept notes

Confirm size, bleed, safe margin, linked assets, fonts, colour mode and export settings before delivery. Print one proof.

Worked example

A business card with 3 mm bleed keeps text inside safe area and exports as print PDF.

Lab assignment

Prepare a flyer and card, run checklist and record proof corrections.

Review questions

1. What is bleed?
2. Why use safe margin?
3. What should proof reveal?

Evidence to submit: source file or working output, screenshot/PDF, and a 100-word explanation of decisions and checks.

Final Applied Assignment

Create one original project that combines all four chapters of DTP & Graphic Design. Use realistic but non-sensitive sample data. Submit planning notes, source files, final output, test evidence and a one-page reflection.

Assessment rubric

Area	Marks
Concept accuracy	25
Working practical output	30
Validation and testing	20
File organisation and presentation	15
Original explanation	10

Student declaration

I confirm that the submitted work is my own practice. I have not included passwords, OTPs, identity documents or confidential student records.

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